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Negotiate Your Salary



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Make the most of your degree and earn the salary you are worth.

Salary Research Resources Before the Interview

- Research the employer website, company culture, schedule/hours and travel requirements





- Research average salaries by industry and location listed on the Bureau of Labor Statistics at http://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oes_nat.htm
- The Texas Workforce Commission also provides salary statistics statewide and by region at <https://www.twc.texas.gov/businesses/labor-market-information>
- The National Association of Colleges and Employers (NACE) provides a salary analysis for job seekers at <http://www.jobsearchintelligence.com/NACE/jobseekers/salary-calculator.php>
- Launch My Career Texas provides average salary information for graduates of select universities (UT Dallas is included): <https://www.air.org/project/launch-my-career>
- In addition, self-reported salary sites such as Salary.com; Glassdoor.com; and Payscale.com may provide additional insight. However, note that self-reported salary resources may be inflated and not as accurate as government provided resources.

The Total Compensation Package is Extremely Important

- Annual compensation is only one part of the compensation package
- Company culture and work environment (office vs. cubicle)
- Exempt or nonexempt position
- Medical and dental insurance employer coverage and employee out-of-pocket costs
- 401K and percentage of employer contribution
- Training or mentor programs provided
- Tuition assistance for graduate degrees or professional certification
- Relocation package (taxable income)
- Sign-on bonus (one-time payment, also taxable income)
- Amount of travel required
- Company benefits such as vehicle, cellular, laptop, iPad, flex time, telecommute privileges



- First, thank the employer for their interest in you. If a salary range has already been provided, you may provide a specific amount you are seeking. Your number should be based on research conducted prior to the interview. When providing an amount, also reference your specific skills and contributions that would benefit the organization to justify your request.
- If no salary amount was posted or disclosed, tell the employer you are open or negotiable and can provide a specific salary when the range is provided.
- If no range is provided, base your salary requirements on the averages you discovered through your research. Take into consideration if you meet or exceed the position requirements and your performance during the interview.
- When the salary is non-negotiable, ask about the frequency of performance evaluations and if salary adjustments are connected. For example, a 5% salary increase may occur after 6-months of employment.
- When an offer is provided, thank the employer and ask about receiving the offer in writing. Reasonable time to consider the offer should be provided; however, if the employer expects a response on-the-spot, request time to discuss this opportunity with your family. “Shotgun” offers are not encouraged and the CMC should be notified if appropriate consideration time is not provided.
- Remember the individual providing the offer will likely be your future supervisor and/or colleague and professionalism during the salary negotiation process helps avoid awkward situations in the office.

CMC Guidelines when Receiving Multiple Job Offers

- The strongest counteroffer is having another offer of a higher amount; therefore, the Career Management Center encourages students to participate in on-campus recruiting activities.
- Consider the total compensation package when evaluating an offer.
- Research the potential career paths available within the organization and consider the skills you would develop for your next position.
- If more than one offer of employment is received, you must respond to every offer, whether you accept or reject it. Accepting multiple offers of employment is unethical and can



- Communicate your acceptance or rejection as promptly as possible so that the employer can notify other candidates about the status of their applications.
- **When you accept an offer (verbally or in writing), your job/internship search is completed and should be discontinued per the JSOM Code of Conduct and Ethics Policy for Employment and Recruitment.**
- Notify the CMC immediately of your accepted offer.

FAQs – Negotiating Your Salary

+ Should I negotiate if I don't have a lot of experience?

+ Where do I look to find out what people with my degree and experience level are paid in the offered job location?

+ How many times should I counteroffer?

+ What if they are pressing me for an immediate answer?

+ What is the average salary for JSOM interns?

+ What should I say if they offer me the job without telling me how much they will pay me?

+ Should I take an unpaid internship if it is offered?

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